

the non-fax MFDs—the Epson and the Canon—have only flatbed scanners.

Needless to say, all support multi-copying: the Brother, Canon, and Epson can do 99 copies each, while the HP stops at 50.

Build Quality And Other Features

All the MFDs here are very ruggedly built. The only chink in the armour of the Brother MFC-440CN is its weak input tray. Brother MFDs have been the heaviest in the other categories, but in this category, it is the lightest (though by no means *light*) at 8.4 kg. The HP is the heaviest at just under 13 kg. The weight is a pain only during the initial setup and isn't a problem later, since these MFDs are not likely to be moved around. Each MFD features a swivelling colour LCD screen that lets you preview images and even apply effects to them.

The control panel on the Canon MFD is hidden under the LCD screen, and also has a unique rotary control wheel (similar to that on the iPod), which we found very intuitive.

The HP Photosmart C6118, a photo MFD, has the reprint function, which lets you restore and make copies from an original photo. The Epson RX650 is the only one that also supports creation of photos from negatives. The HP also has a Photo Fix function, which can apply effects like red-eye reduction to scanned photos, and photos from memory cards and digicams, before printing.

PictBridge and memory cards were standard fare, though the Epson RX650 supports more memory card standards. The Canon and Epson feature IrDA, so you can print directly from an infrared device like your camera phone. Bluetooth would have been better, since this is *de facto* now,

and faster and more popular than infrared. The HP and Brother feature Ethernet ports. HP goes one step further and supports Wi-Fi (802.11g) that bestows upon Laptops and PDA phones the convenience of wireless printing.

Performance Printing

The Canon MP600 seems to have an insatiable hunger for paper—sheets went in, and normal-quality black-and-white prints popped out in just 7.8 seconds! The slowest is the Brother. The others fall in between.

The print quality of all the

colour scan—quite obviously the slowest.

As before, the Canon MP600 is the fastest and best copier—it reproduces even the finest of details with great accuracy.

Which One To Buy?

In the Home category, the Canon PIXMA MP160, with the best print, copy, and scan quality, and fast at that, is the Digit Best Buy Gold winner. With its print quality, memory card reader, and Photo Reprint function, but no PictBridge, the HP Photosmart C3188 All-in-One takes the Digit Best Buy Silver in that category.

The populous Office category was the most competitive. The HP Photosmart C4188 All-in-One has photoprinting features like a photo paper cassette and a colour LCD and memory card reader, and also performs well—especially in photo printing. At Rs 7,999, this one gets the Digit Best Buy Gold. With its speed and excellent print quality, the Canon PIXMA MP460 takes the Silver, let down only by its stiffer Rs 9,995 price tag.

It's ironic that the winners don't have fax—if that's essential, we recommend the Brother DCP-330C and MFC-240C. The Lexmark X4270 and HP 4355 are good if you're on a budget, and if your workload is moderate; the HP 5610 and 5680 will handle bigger workloads better.

Photo printing, Ethernet, Wi-Fi, memory card reader, fax, you name it—the HP Photosmart C6188 All-in-One has it all. Performance matches features, here, and at Rs 15,999, it is a very attractive choice for anyone setting up a photo studio. Without a doubt, this is the Digit Best Buy Gold winner in the Professional category.

The Canon PIXMA MP600 is stylish, and specialises in photo printing. It produces life-like photo prints—better than those by any other MFD in this test. This one manages to deliver excellent results at the fastest speeds. With a very intuitive interface, this MFD gets the Digit Best Buy Silver in the Professional category. ☒

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Canon PIXMA MP600

Amazing, life-like photo prints

MFDs here is exceptional except for the Epson. This one's photo prints are clear and sharp, but overall, the prints have a yellow tinge.

The Canon and the HP are the best in terms of print quality across the tests, and should be every professional photographer's dream come true.

Scanning And Copying

All the MFDs here are good at scanning, but the HP Photosmart C6188 is exceptionally so. It produces the best scans we've seen in this test, and takes just 9.1 seconds for a black-and-white scan.

The Epson Stylus Photo RX650 is the slowest, taking over 22 seconds for the same job. It also took over 3 minutes to complete a

Contact Sheet—Inkjet MFDs

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